

Microsoft Sidewinder X5 Mouse

A Cheaper Sidewinder Arrives

Microsoft's other introduction to the family of gaming peripherals is the Sidewinder X5 mouse. It is almost identical to the previous Sidewinder we've tested, except for a few minor changes. The Sidewinder X5 is a laser mouse with a 2000 dpi sensor.

The mouse is still huge, and the entire body has a matte plastic finish except the sides, which have an anti-bacterial finish. The two buttons on the side are available as well. Three lit-buttons on the top can be used to change the DPI on the fly. The DPI that you want to use for each of the three buttons can be set through the drivers.

The scroll has a clicky-feel to it and the buttons feel

cheaper. The scroll movement is smooth though; the mechanism is robust and lets the scroll wheel stay very steady. The surface pads at the bottom of the mouse were changeable before, but are not now. The drivers allow a good amount of customisation.

The mouse performs flawlessly in games. There is no skipping whatsoever at any of the resolutions. The buttons on the side are suitably placed and are useful while playing.

Overall, this mouse is a big downgrade in terms of features. The performance is still great. Is it as good as the best gaming mice today? It is. For users who were never really impressed by weights and LED screens, but just

wanted a pure gaming mouse, the X5 might be just perfect.

The price for the Microsoft Sidewinder X5 is Rs 2,867, which is only a little better than the earlier Sidewinder which was priced around Rs 3,000.

Specifications:

2000 DPI laser tracker, Refresh rate: 500 Hz, 5 programmable buttons.

Contact: Microsoft Hardware
Phone: 9886328580
E-mail: geethakb@microsoft.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com/india/edd/
Price: Rs 2,867



RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Altec Lansing VS2521

Underpowered And Overpriced

The Altec Lansing VS2521 is a 2.1 speaker set whose design looks a lot like the BXR1121 speakers from Altec Lansing. These aren't the prettiest speakers for sure, and the woofer looks like a small grey box.

The woofer has a down-firing driver and a lot of great things can't be said about its performance. The satellites are loud but the

woofer isn't all that impressive. It isn't loud enough to complement the satellites, and distorts easily. The low range frequencies aren't generated properly either.

The satellites on the other hand are really great. The sound was crisp and detailed through all of the test tracks we ran on it. The poor bass means it isn't as great for movies or games. For music that doesn't

depend a lot on bass, these speakers would be great. The highs aren't very sturdy either. When we played tracks with choir vocals, the high-end range easily distorts. Even though they are rated at 28 W RMS, they are still pretty loud.

One satellite speaker has controls for the treble, bass and the volume. There are connectors for mic-in and headphones.

The Altec Lansing VS2521 speakers are available for a MRP of Rs 3,199, which you may find a little expensive for the way it performs.

Specifications:

Satellites frequency range: 180 Hz to 20 kHz, woofer frequency range: 30 Hz to 180 Hz, Total power: 28 W RMS

Contact: Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd
Phone: 022-67090828
E-mail: response@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.alteclansing.com
Price: Rs 3,199



RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Viewsonic VP2650WB

Almost Affordable

Sleek LCD screens have taken the place of the huge ugly boxes that CRTs were. With smaller footprints and larger screen sizes, even screens as large as 24 and 26 inches are practical for everyday use.

The 26-inch Viewsonic VP2650WB runs at a resolution of 1920 x 1200 — the same used on 24-inch screens. The design of the screen is simple and nothing like some of the more stylish but smaller screens. There are no inbuilt speakers, no rounded bezels here. A fairly thin border surrounds the screen, but the back is rather bulky. The stand mechanism is useful and allows the screen to be lifted, rotate and even swivel. The stand is sturdy and doesn't let the screen shake a lot. The raising and lowering system is smooth, but gives a little more resistance than some of the

similarly behaving stands we've seen.

The VP2650WB is a TN panel, which means the best of colours and viewing angles can't be expected. With the screen can be set up without any tweaking, the colours are too gaudy. With the screen calibrated, the colours and contrast improved significantly. The colours look natural and the clarity is perfect. This is a large screen, and if you sit too close to it, the edges start to look at little blurry. Viewing angles in general are pretty good for a TN panel, except when looked at from below. Contrast ratios are also decent.

Other than DVI and VGA, the screen can be used as a USB hub. There are four ports at the back of the screen. Using the screen is also simple. All the navigation is done through four buttons on the front of the screen.



A 26-inch LCD screen is really a joy to work with, but the price of Rs 30,999 could stop you from buying this one today. A 24-inch TN panel LCD screen is considerably cheaper, and also runs at the same resolution. Only those who want a larger screen would consider this. If you want your media running on a large desktop

screen, then the VP2650WB is for you.

Specifications:

Maximum supported resolution: 1920 x 1200, Power consumption: 110 W, Contrast Ratio: 1000:1 Dimensions: 59.5 x 46.8 x 38.8 cm, Weight: 14.4 kg.

Contact: Viewsonic Technologies India Pvt Ltd.
Phone: 022-2668 1921
E-mail: viewsonic@redington.co.in
Web site: http://in.viewsonic.com
Price: Rs 30,999

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Belkin Washable Mouse

That's Right! Washable!

Belkin's other product we received this issue was also one of the most unique ones. This mouse is, as the name gives away, is very washable. In size, it's the size of most laptop mice and shaped a little differently.

The body has no crevices for water to seep into the mouse itself. The biggest problem with making a mouse waterproof has to be the scroll wheel region. It has been replaced with a touch sensitive pad. The pad works fairly well and is probably nicer for people who don't like the gritty feel of most mouse scroll wheels. The same touch sensitive strip allows you to do side

scrolling as well. There is no middle click though. The sensor region also appears to be sealed off to prevent any water from getting inside.

The mouse buttons are hidden away under a membrane of rubber too. The buttons are placed towards the center of the mouse which means those used to clicking at the extreme end of the mouse will have to readjust.

The performance of the mouse in general is OK. This is a 1200 dpi mouse, but it somehow doesn't feel as smooth as some of the other mice. This isn't the best mouse for gaming, but it will do just fine for general desktop use.

The cable isn't as long as some other desktop mice, but then this is a mouse geared towards laptop users.

Another great thing about the mouse is the circular strip under it, which lets it slide about with little resistance.

We washed the mouse with water to test its claim, and it worked perfectly later. One thing is for sure, if you're the type who

eats at a computer, and want to wash your mouse and hands together later, there really isn't anything else available!

Specifications:

1200-dpi optical sensor, waterproof, touch-sensitive mouse scroll

Contact: Belkin Asia Pacific Limited
Phone: 9810889785
E-mail: MadhuJ@belkin.com
Web site: www.belkin.in
Price: Rs 2,099

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

